

SHEIKH ABDUL 'ENGINEER' RASHID

Baramulla MP; Founder, Awami Ittehad Party



SAJAD GHANI LONE

Former MLA; Chairman, J&K People's Conference



SYED MOHAMMAD ALTAF BUKHARI

President, J&K Apni Party



RAVINDER RAINA

Former MLA; President, J&K BJP

● **TARIQ HAMEED KARRA** This is an unusual election and is of paramount importance to the people of Jammu and Kashmir.



● **ENGINEER RASHID:** This election will defeat Modi's effort for a so-called Naya Kashmir. It should lead to people taking the subcontinent out of the mess and the best way to do that is to resolve the Kashmir issue.

● **SAJAD LONE:** I don't see a lot of fervour on the ground. One of the reasons is that it is for a state assembly that people think will not have a lot of power to bring change in their lives. The other could be that it's the farming season and people are busy. The ECI should have thought f that.

> **"For us, resolving the Kashmir issue is the priority. Then come unemployment, inflation, the environment, and drug addiction"**
>
> **— MEHBOOBA MUFTI**

● **ALTAF BUKHARI:** This is the first step towards getting back what has been taken away from us by New Delhi. And people in J&K realise that the best way to do it is through the ballot.

● **RAVINDER RAINA:** This election will decide the fate and fortune of J&K. There is a new Kashmir the world is seeing. ■

Q. What are the key election issues?

● **OMAR ABDULLAH:** If you set aside the sort of changes that were foisted upon us by the abrogation of Article 370, there are everyday issues that people are facing that only got worse in the past few years rather than better. So, it's about basic governance and delivery of services. It's about the rising unemployment. It's about the missing investment that was talked about but doesn't seem to be visible on the ground. It's about projects that are talked about but aren't being implemented. It's also